

CITIPointe CHURCH · NASHVILLE

Multiply

disciples making disciples

LIFEGROUP AGENDAS

Season One · twelve weeks

SAY THIS ON THE FIRST NIGHT

The point of lifegroup is not just that people attend a lifegroup. The point is that you all would eventually turn around and take someone else with you. The focus on growth is not for growth's sake. It is because we want to see more souls saved in Nashville and see a community of people on fire for Jesus. That takes discipleship.

This group runs on the expectation that people read the book, but it is not required to take part. Over the next twelve weeks, this is what our meetings will look like.

One sheet per week. Times are a shape, not a rule: the meal is the point, not the preamble, and honoring the clock honors the guest.

Question numbers match the member companion, so "question two" means the same thing in every hand at the table.

What Is a Disciple?

1 hr 55 min total

WHAT THE CHAPTER SAYS

Book pp. 15–26

- A disciple is an apprentice, and an apprentice ends up like his teacher (Luke 6:40).
- So a Christian who is not becoming like Christ is a contradiction, not a category.
- Repent means turn. It is an action, not an opinion.
- Salvation is grace through faith; part of repenting is giving up the idea that you contribute anything.
- Lord is a title meaning master and owner, so confessing Him means you do not write your own job description.
- It is not joyless duty: it comes down to love of God and neighbor, and obedience is what love looks like.
- Luke 14 asks you to count the cost before you start.

AFTER
START

start DINNER

30 MIN The meal is the point, not the preamble. Eat together, linger, and make the new person feel expected.

+30m TABLE AND WINS

10 MIN Table cleared together, then wins: a testimony, an answered prayer, someone joining a team. Nobody stands on their own.

+40m COMMUNION

10 MIN Every table, every gathering. Use the Communion guide; resources on Sundays or midweek from the office.

+50m GOOD QUESTION

10 MIN Go around the table: how did you first come to be around church or around Jesus?

+1h 0m READ, THEN DISCUSS

35 MIN Read: Luke 6:40 and Luke 14:25 to 33. Then work the questions in order; same numbers as their companion.

1. Luke 6:40 says a fully trained disciple becomes like his teacher. If that is the definition, what should be visibly true of someone who has followed Jesus for ten years?
2. Jesus tells two stories about counting the cost, a builder and a king. Why would He make it harder to follow Him rather than easier? What does that tell you about what He is after?
3. Where in your life is there a gap between what you say you believe and how you actually live? Be specific with yourself. You do not have to say it out loud yet.

+1h 35m

10 MIN

LAND IT

Ask each person to name one specific thing this week that would look different if Luke 14 were true of them.

+1h 45m

10 MIN

PRAYER, THEN SEND

Requests and praise reports, prayed for together. Finish on time: honoring the clock honors the guest.

The Command to Make Disciples

1 hr 55 min total

WHAT THE CHAPTER SAYS

Book pp. 27–38

- The disciples expected Jesus to fix the world. Instead He handed them the job and ascended.
- Matthew 28 is read as addressed to pastors and missionaries. It was addressed to them, and to us.
- We have built a culture where paid ministers do ministry and everyone else attends and leaves fed.
- Disciple making is not a program to complete. A disciple is by definition a disciple maker.
- The commission has three parts: go, baptize, teach obedience.
- Baptism was a public declaration of allegiance that marked people for hostility.
- Leaders equip; every member does the ministry (Ephesians 4). The usual excuses have no exception clause.

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+40m COMMUNION

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+50m GOOD QUESTION

10 MIN Who taught you something that stuck?

+1h 0m READ, THEN DISCUSS

35 MIN Read: Matthew 28:16 to 20. Then work the questions in order; same numbers as their companion.

1. Verse 17 says some doubted, and Jesus commissioned them anyway. What does that do to the idea that you have to have it together before God uses you?
2. “Teaching them to observe all that I have commanded.” Not teaching them to know. What is the difference, and which one does most church teaching actually aim at?
3. Who is one person in your life who is not far from you and might say yes to walking through this together?

+1h 35m

10 MIN

LAND IT

Everyone writes down two or three names of people they could invest in.

+1h 45m

10 MIN

PRAYER, THEN SEND

Requests and praise reports, prayed for together. Finish on time: honoring the clock honors the guest.

The Heart of a Disciple Maker

1 hr 55 min total

WHAT THE CHAPTER SAYS

Book pp. 39–50

- Wrong motives do not make ministry neutral. They can make it harmful.
- The Pharisees were constantly ministering and are the villains of the Gospels.
- God looks at the heart, not the outward appearance (1 Samuel 16:7).
- To the reluctant: God wants ministry done from joy, not obligation.
- To the eager: teaching is dangerous. James 3 on the tongue is a warning, not a flourish.
- Every gift and all knowledge amount to nothing without love (1 Corinthians 13).
- Teaching what you do not practice is hypocrisy, and Hebrews 13:7 assumes a life open to examination.
- You do not need to be perfect to start. You do need to have counted the cost.

AFTER
START

- | | |
|------------------|---|
| start
30 MIN | DINNER
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10 MIN | TABLE AND WINS
Table cleared together, then wins: a testimony, an answered prayer, someone joining a team. Nobody stands on their own. |
| +40m
10 MIN | COMMUNION
Every table, every gathering. Use the Communion guide; resources on Sundays or midweek from the office. |
| +50m
10 MIN | GOOD QUESTION
Tell us about a time you did the right thing for the wrong reason. |
| +1h 0m
35 MIN | READ, THEN DISCUSS
Read: James 3:1 to 12, then 1 Corinthians 13:1 to 3. Then work the questions in order; same numbers as their companion. |
1. 1 Corinthians 13 says you can have every gift and be nothing without love. What does that mean for someone who is good at explaining the Bible but hard to be around?
 2. Chan asks why you want to make disciples. Sit with that. What are the wrong reasons, and which of them do you recognize in yourself?
 3. Hebrews 13:7 says to consider the outcome of their way of life and imitate their faith. That assumes leaders whose lives can be watched. What does that require of a leader, practically?

+1h 35m

10 MIN

LAND IT

Ask each person to name one area where their life does not yet match what they would teach.

+1h 45m

10 MIN

PRAYER, THEN SEND

Requests and praise reports, prayed for together. Finish on time: honoring the clock honors the guest.

Life in the Church

1 hr 55 min total

WHAT THE CHAPTER SAYS

Book pp. 51–64

- The West admires people who go it alone. You cannot follow Jesus that way.
- The New Testament is full of one another commands, and it is impossible to one another yourself.
- Of roughly 114 New Testament uses of church, at least ninety mean a specific local gathering.
- People avoid commitment for real reasons: self sufficiency, fear of accountability, church hopping, past hurt.
- Ministry is not intimidating once you see it as serving the people already around you (Galatians 6:1 to 2).
- We treat symptoms. Manage an angry man's triggers and nothing changes, because it comes from the heart (Mark 7).
- Only God changes hearts, through His Spirit, His Word and prayer (Ezekiel 36:26 to 27).
- A body grows only when each part works; an inactive member makes the rest compensate.

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+40m COMMUNION

10 MIN Every table, every gathering. Use the Communion guide; resources on Sundays or midweek from the office.

+50m GOOD QUESTION

10 MIN What is the best experience of community you have ever had, in or out of church?

+1h 0m READ, THEN DISCUSS

35 MIN Read: Acts 2:42 to 47, then Hebrews 10:24 to 25. Then work the questions in order; same numbers as their companion.

1. Acts 2 describes a group who devoted themselves to teaching, fellowship, breaking bread, and prayer, and who shared possessions. Which of those four is weakest in your experience of church? Why?
2. Chan pushes for getting beneath the surface. What keeps us at the surface with each other? Name the actual mechanisms, not just “we’re busy.”
3. What is one gift or capacity you have that the body is not currently getting from you?

+1h 35m

10 MIN

LAND IT

Each person names one specific act of service or encouragement toward someone in the church this week.

+1h 45m

10 MIN

PRAYER, THEN SEND

Requests and praise reports, prayed for together. Finish on time: honoring the clock honors the guest.

The Local Church

1 hr 55 min total

WHAT THE CHAPTER SAYS

Book pp. 65–76

- Everything about devotion to one another still stands, and it is not the point.
- An inwardly focused church is unhealthy, dying, and biblically not a church at all.
- We are a lighthouse rather than a bomb shelter: not hiding from trouble but guiding others through it.
- The world identifies disciples by love, not by doctrine or morality (John 13:34 to 35).
- Jesus prayed for unity so the world would believe (John 17). We assume arguments will convince; He said unity would.
- That prayer assumes our life together is visible. Hidden church life proves nothing to anyone.
- 1 Peter 3 assumes we suffer unjustly and respond with such hope that people ask. Mostly nobody asks.
- Israel was a kingdom of priests; the church now carries that calling (1 Peter 2:9).

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+40m COMMUNION

10 MIN Every table, every gathering. Use the Communion guide; resources on Sundays or midweek from the office.

+50m GOOD QUESTION

10 MIN What do people in Nashville who do not go to church think church is?

+1h 0m READ, THEN DISCUSS

35 MIN Read: John 13:34 to 35, then John 17:20 to 23, then Matthew 5:14 to 16. Then work the questions in order; same numbers as their companion.

1. Jesus says the world will identify His disciples by their love for one another. Not by doctrine, not by morality, by love. Why that? And is that how we are actually identified?
2. In John 17 Jesus prays for unity so that the world may believe. What is the connection between a united church and a believing world?
3. Chan says your local church matters. If your congregation disappeared tomorrow, would the neighborhood notice? What would be missing?

+1h 35m

10 MIN

LAND IT

Pick one thing the group could do together for the neighborhood in the next month.

+1h 45m

10 MIN

PRAYER, THEN SEND

Requests and praise reports, prayed for together. Finish on time: honoring the clock honors the guest.

The Global Church

1 hr 55 min total

WHAT THE CHAPTER SAYS

Book pp. 77–90

- Reaching everyone in your town still would not finish the mission.
- Genesis 3:15 promises a rescuer for the human race, not for one ethnic group.
- Genesis 12 narrows to one family precisely so all families of the earth are blessed.
- Paul was a missionary before he was a theologian, ambitious to preach where Christ was not named.
- Romans 10 gives the chain: calling needs believing, believing needs hearing, hearing needs preaching, preaching needs sending.
- Many groups still have no access to the gospel. The assumption that anyone interested can find it is false.
- Everyone is involved; not everyone goes. Go, send, pray, learn are all real responses.

AFTER
START

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+30m TABLE AND WINS

10 MIN Table cleared together, then wins: a testimony, an answered prayer, someone joining a team. Nobody stands on their own.

+40m COMMUNION

10 MIN Every table, every gathering. Use the Communion guide; resources on Sundays or midweek from the office.

+50m GOOD QUESTION

10 MIN Where in the world have you been, and what surprised you about the church there if you saw it?

+1h 0m READ, THEN DISCUSS

35 MIN Read: Genesis 12:1 to 3, then Romans 10:12 to 15, then Revelation 7:9 to 10. Then work the questions in order; same numbers as their companion.

1. Romans 10 works backward: calling, believing, hearing, preaching, sending. Which link in that chain is your church strongest at? Which is weakest?
2. Revelation 7 shows a multitude from every nation, tribe, people, and language. Not one culture absorbed into another, all of them present. What does that say about God's view of the nations?
3. Is there any reason you should not go? Ask it seriously. Not everyone should, but most people have never actually asked.

+1h 35m

10 MIN

LAND IT

Each person picks one unreached people group to learn about and pray for this month.

+1h 45m

10 MIN

PRAYER, THEN SEND

Requests and praise reports, prayed for together. Finish on time: honoring the clock honors the guest.

Why Study the Bible?

WHAT THE CHAPTER SAYS

Book pp. 91–108

- Disciple making means teaching obedience, so we have to know what Jesus commanded.
- We are not at a disadvantage for having missed Jesus in person. It was written down.
- Three wrong motives: guilt, which breeds legalism and quotas; status; and hunting for teaching material.
- God gave the Bible to teach us about Himself, about ourselves and the world, and to make us godly.
- Also to build relationship with Him, to exalt Jesus, and to prepare us for mission.
- We think we read the Bible. In fact it reads us (Hebrews 4:12).
- Approach it as a student rather than searching for agreement with what you already hold.
- Knowledge puffs up. Bible study has produced some of the most arrogant people alive.

AFTER START

start DINNER

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+30m TABLE AND WINS

10 MIN Table cleared together, then wins: a testimony, an answered prayer, someone joining a team. Nobody stands on their own.

+40m COMMUNION

10 MIN Every table, every gathering. Use the Communion guide; resources on Sundays or midweek from the office.

+50m GOOD QUESTION

10 MIN What is your actual history with the Bible?

+1h 0m READ, THEN DISCUSS

35 MIN Read: 2 Timothy 3:16 to 17, then 1 Peter 2:1 to 3. Then work the questions in order; same numbers as their companion.

1. Paul lists four uses: teaching, reproof, correction, training in righteousness. Which of those do you actually let the Bible do to you? Which do you skip?
2. Chan names wrong motives for Bible study: guilt, status, gathering teaching material. Which of those has driven you? Be specific.
3. 1 Corinthians 8:1 says knowledge puffs up. How do you study seriously without becoming that person?

+1h 35m LAND IT

10 MIN

Everyone sets a Bible reading plan for the next month: what, when, where.

+1h 45m PRAYER, THEN SEND

10 MIN

Requests and praise reports, prayed for together. Finish on time: honoring the clock honors the guest.

Studying the Bible Prayerfully and Obediently

DATE _____ START _____

1 hr 55 min total

WHAT THE CHAPTER SAYS

Book pp. 109–122

- People handle Scripture as rulebook, character gallery, mystical oracle, or academic object. Most of us cycle through all four.
- Read it devotionally, meaning devoted. Psalm 119 is 176 verses of delight in God's word.
- We talk about praying and reading. We rarely pray while reading.
- Enough exegesis, Greek and commentaries will not do it. That mentality leaves no room for the Spirit.
- You cannot understand Scripture without the Holy Spirit (1 Corinthians 2:14).
- Dependence on revelation is not a result of the fall; Adam needed it before there was any sin.
- Read expecting to obey. Study that never becomes action is misuse.
- Read with faith: the promises are as trustworthy as the God who makes them.

AFTER
START

start DINNER
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10 MIN Table cleared together, then wins: a testimony, an answered prayer, someone joining a team. Nobody stands on their own.

+40m COMMUNION
10 MIN Every table, every gathering. Use the Communion guide; resources on Sundays or midweek from the office.

+50m GOOD QUESTION
10 MIN Tell about a time you understood something in the Bible that you had read many times before but never seen.

+1h 0m READ, THEN DISCUSS

35 MIN

Read: 1 Corinthians 2:9 to 14, then James 1:22 to 25. Then work the questions in order; same numbers as their companion.

1. If understanding Scripture depends on the Spirit, what does that look like practically when you sit down to read? What would change about the first two minutes?
2. Chan argues we should read expecting to obey. How would your reading change if you assumed every passage required a response?
3. Have you ever avoided a part of the Bible because you knew what it would ask of you? Which part?

+1h 35m LAND IT

10 MIN

Take the passage each person is reading this week and have them write one question: what does this ask me to do?

+1h 45m PRAYER, THEN SEND

10 MIN

Requests and praise reports, prayed for together. Finish on time: honoring the clock honors the guest.

Studying Logically

1 hr 55 min total

WHAT THE CHAPTER SAYS

Book pp. 123–138

- Careful work does not guarantee right results, and it is still commanded (2 Timothy 2:15).
- We all misread some passages. If we did not, we would agree on every point of doctrine.
- Context first. Think apple rather than orange: a verse is a bite from a whole, not a detached segment.
- A passage has one meaning and many applications. Reverse that and misinterpretation stops existing.
- Find the plain meaning. Luke 12:33 is the test case we reflexively explain away.
- If the literal sense makes sense, seek no other sense, allowing for metaphor, parable and poetry.
- Historical context matters: Jeremiah 29:11 was written to exiles, not printed for coffee mugs.
- The biggest danger is your own baggage, cultural and personal.

AFTER
START

start 30 MIN	DINNER The meal is the point, not the preamble. Eat together, linger, and make the new person feel expected.
+30m 10 MIN	TABLE AND WINS Table cleared together, then wins: a testimony, an answered prayer, someone joining a team. Nobody stands on their own.
+40m 10 MIN	COMMUNION Every table, every gathering. Use the Communion guide; resources on Sundays or midweek from the office.
+50m 10 MIN	GOOD QUESTION What is a verse you have seen used in a way that felt off?
+1h 0m 35 MIN	READ, THEN DISCUSS Read: 2 Timothy 2:15, then read your practice passage twice: once alone, then with the surrounding paragraph. Then work the questions in order; same numbers as their companion. 1. Read the practice verse by itself. What do people usually take it to mean? 2. Now read the paragraph around it. What is the writer actually talking about? What changes? 3. Chan distinguishes interpretation from application. A passage has one meaning and many applications. Why does that order matter? What goes wrong when we reverse it?

+1h 35m LAND IT

10 MIN

Each person takes a passage this week and writes three lines: what it says, what it means, what it asks of me.

+1h 45m PRAYER, THEN SEND

10 MIN

Requests and praise reports, prayed for together. Finish on time: honoring the clock honors the guest.

Creation

1 hr 55 min total

WHAT THE CHAPTER SAYS

Book pp. 139–150

- The Bible tells one true story, and it is unfinished. You have a part in it.
- Genesis never answers our philosophical questions about God. It tells us what He did: He created.
- God is the only character in Genesis 1 and the only eternal one, so nothing compares with Him.
- This world is His because He spoke it into being. Our authority over it is delegated, not owned.
- Image of God: rather than pin it to one faculty, read it as reflecting Him. Jesus does so perfectly (Colossians 1:15).
- Kings set up images of themselves to announce who ruled. Humans standing in creation do the same.
- Genesis 2 is more intimate: God forms, breathes, speaks. Adam needed revelation even before sin.
- Work exists before the fall. The curse made it frustrating; it did not invent it.

AFTER
START

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+40m COMMUNION

10 MIN Every table, every gathering. Use the Communion guide; resources on Sundays or midweek from the office.

+50m GOOD QUESTION

10 MIN What is something in the natural world that has stopped you in your tracks?

+1h 0m READ, THEN DISCUSS

35 MIN Read: Genesis 1:26 to 28 and Genesis 2:15. Then work the questions in order; same numbers as their companion.

1. Before anything else, Genesis 1 tells us about God. What is He like, based only on this chapter?
2. What does it mean to be made in God's image? What is it about humans that is not true of anything else God made?
3. If every human bears God's image, what follows for how you treat the person you find hardest to be around?

+1h 35m LAND IT

10 MIN

Ask each person to identify one person they habitually treat as less than image bearing, and one concrete thing they will do about it this week.

+1h 45m PRAYER, THEN SEND

10 MIN

Requests and praise reports, prayed for together. Finish on time: honoring the clock honors the guest.

The Fall

1 hr 55 min total

WHAT THE CHAPTER SAYS

Book pp. 151–160

- You felt the results of the fall today. Everyone senses the world is not as it should be.
- The serpent points at the one restriction so Eve feels deprived, then promises she will be like God.
- The garden was already full of good things. What he offered was goodness apart from God.
- He is subtle, and he is a creature. Be wary of his lies without fearing his power.
- Sin is always a declaration of autonomy: the right to decide good and evil for yourself.
- They had God's word and let another voice outrank it.
- The damage is total: hiding, shame, exile, blame, pain, cursed ground, and death.
- Genesis 4 to 11 makes it worse, and Genesis 3:15 already promises a rescuer.

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START

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10 MIN Table cleared together, then wins: a testimony, an answered prayer, someone joining a team. Nobody stands on their own.

+40m COMMUNION

10 MIN Every table, every gathering. Use the Communion guide; resources on Sundays or midweek from the office.

+50m GOOD QUESTION

10 MIN What is something you have broken that could not be fixed?

+1h 0m READ, THEN DISCUSS

35 MIN Read: Genesis 3, the whole chapter. Then work the questions in order; same numbers as their companion.

1. Trace how the serpent works in verses 1 to 5. What is the sequence? Where do you recognize it in your own temptations?
2. The first consequence is hiding. Why is shame the immediate result rather than punishment?
3. Genesis 3:15 is the first promise of a rescuer, spoken in the middle of a curse. What does it tell you about God that judgment and promise arrive in the same breath?

+1h 35m

10 MIN

LAND IT

Where is the pattern of Genesis 3 running in your life right now?

+1h 45m

10 MIN

PRAYER, THEN SEND

Requests and praise reports, prayed for together. Finish on time: honoring the clock honors the guest.

God's Covenant with Abraham

1 hr 55 min total

WHAT THE CHAPTER SAYS

Book pp. 161–172

- A rhythm has emerged: people sin, they face the consequences, God redeems.
- After scattering the nations at Babel, God immediately promises to bless all of them.
- The covenant runs through Genesis 12, 15 and 17. Land is central to it.
- Covenant partners walked between severed animals, invoking that fate on themselves. God walked alone.
- So the covenant holds regardless of what Abraham's descendants do.
- The greatest blessing God offers is Himself: I will be your God and you will be my people.
- Galatians 3 says that in you all the nations will be blessed was the gospel preached in advance.
- God's blessings are to be shared, not hoarded. Abraham believed, and it was counted as righteousness.

AFTER
START

start DINNER
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10 MIN Table cleared together, then wins: a testimony, an answered prayer, someone joining a team. Nobody stands on their own.

+40m COMMUNION
10 MIN Every table, every gathering. Use the Communion guide; resources on Sundays or midweek from the office.

+50m GOOD QUESTION
10 MIN Have you ever left somewhere without knowing where you were going?

+1h 0m READ, THEN DISCUSS

35 MIN

Read: Genesis 12:1 to 9, then Genesis 15:1 to 21. Then work the questions in order; same numbers as their companion.

1. God tells Abram to leave without telling him the destination. What kind of faith does that require? Where has God asked something like that of you?
2. In Genesis 15 the animals are cut in half and God alone passes between the pieces while Abram sleeps. In that culture both parties walked the path. What is God saying by walking it alone?
3. Genesis 15:6 says Abram believed the LORD and it was counted to him as righteousness. Paul builds his whole argument for justification by faith on that verse. Why does it matter that this comes centuries before the law?

+1h 35m LAND IT

10 MIN

Where is God asking you to move without showing you the destination?

+1h 45m PRAYER, THEN SEND

10 MIN

Requests and praise reports, prayed for together. Finish on time: honoring the clock honors the guest.